Sihanouk's representatives, inviting the East German foreign minister, and boycotting the Jakarta conference on Indonesia.[92] Mishra also highlighted that Beijing, reacting to India-Japan foreign ministerial discussions, directed its wrath toward Tokyo, rather than Delhi. He contrasted this with the tirade against India when Gandhi had visited Japan the year before. Mishra also detected "a quantitative as well as qualitative change" in China's anti-India rhetoric.[93] Moreover, Yugoslavian diplomats informed India that Chinese officials had indicated that Beijing would not reject an Indian initiative, and "non-normalization" of Sino-Indian ties was only serving the interest of "imperialists."[94]

Mishra was simultaneously observing that, despite anti-American vitriol, China was keeping the door "slightly ajar" to the US.[95] This seemed to fit with Kosygin's statement to the Indian foreign secretary that Chinese officials "are shouting against American imperialism yet they have their contacts with them."[96]

Skeptics like Defense Minister Swaran Singh publicly stated that there was little hope for or evidence of any response from China to India's overtures. In his subsequent role as foreign minister, he acknowledged a "slight change in attitude," but no substantive shift.[97] On the one hand, Chinese officials were indicating to third parties that they were merely waiting for an Indian initiative, but on the other hand, they were not responding to Indian indications that they were ready to have discussions.[98] Furthermore, China was indicating to Yugoslavian officials that India was the country that was not ready for talks.[99] Finally, China had continued to complain about what they considered anti-Chinese activities in India.[100] Over time, even Mishra grew frustrated about Chinese officials' lack of response.[101]

China's regional behavior also remained a source of concern for India. China continued arms supply to Pakistan and promised $200 million in economic aid in November.[102] Intelligence assessments indicated continued Chinese road construction to Pakistan and establishment of an ordnance factory in East Pakistan.[103] Indian officials worried about Chinese "mischief" in Nepal and intrusion into Bhutan. Delhi remained apprehensive about Beijing's intentions in Bhutan, especially as Thimphu's foreign policymaking became more independent. India was also anxious